

Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_ Score: \_\_\_\_\_ / 30

## Reading Comprehension Test

1 Samuel - Bible  
by Old Testament

Directions: Circle the letter of the best answer for each question.

### Section 1: Easy

**1. Who was the mother of Samuel?**

- A. Hannah
- B. Ruth
- C. Michal
- D. Abigail

**2. Where did Hannah take Samuel to serve after God answered her prayer?**

- A. The palace in Jerusalem
- B. The tabernacle at Shiloh
- C. The fields near Bethlehem
- D. The cave of Adullam

**3. Who was the priest who raised Samuel at Shiloh?**

- A. Saul
- B. David
- C. Jonathan
- D. Eli

**4. What did Israel demand from Samuel when they wanted to be like other nations?**

- A. A larger army of Philistines
- B. A new temple made of stone
- C. A king to rule over them
- D. A different law from Moses

**5. Who became the first king of Israel?**

- A. Saul
- B. David
- C. Samuel
- D. Jonathan

**6. Which enemy champion did David fight with a sling and a stone?**

- A. Doeg
- B. Nabal
- C. Agag
- D. Goliath

**7. Who was Saul's son and David's close friend?**

- A. Abner
- B. Jonathan
- C. Eliab
- D. Jesse

**8. What job did David have before becoming famous in Saul's court?**

- A. He was a fisherman on the Sea of Galilee
- B. He was a priest at Shiloh
- C. He was a shepherd
- D. He was a tax collector

**9. Which prophet anointed David while Saul was still king?**

- A. Nathan
- B. Elijah
- C. Moses
- D. Samuel

**10. Where did Saul and his sons die in battle?**

- A. Mount Gilboa
- B. Jericho
- C. Bethlehem
- D. Shiloh

**Section 2: Medium****11. Why did Hannah give Samuel to serve the Lord at Shiloh?**

- A. She wanted Samuel to gain royal power before Israel even had a king
- B. She had promised him to the Lord after praying for a son
- C. Eli forced her to leave Samuel there
- D. Samuel refused to live with his family

**12. What did Samuel learn when God called him during the night?**

- A. That Eli would lead Israel into a completely peaceful age with no enemies left
- B. That Israel would never fight again
- C. That Saul was hiding among the baggage
- D. That God was giving him a hard message about Eli's house

**13. Why was Israel's request for a king spiritually serious?**

- A. It showed they were rejecting the Lord as their true king
- B. It meant Samuel had never judged Israel faithfully and needed to move far away
- C. It proved other nations were more righteous than Israel
- D. It ended all of God's promises to Abraham

**14. Why did Saul lose God's favor as king?**

- A. He was too young to lead soldiers
- B. He refused to let Israel have any priests during all his years as king
- C. He disobeyed God's commands and made excuses
- D. He showed mercy to David at the wrong time

**15. What did Samuel mean when he said obedience is better than sacrifice?**

- A. Sacrifices were never allowed in Israel and had no place in worship at all
- B. Only priests needed to obey God
- C. King Saul had offered too many animals
- D. God wanted Saul's faithful obedience more than religious excuses

**16. Why did God choose David instead of one of Jesse's older sons?**

- A. God looked at the heart, not only outward appearance

- B. David was taller than all his brothers and already wore Saul's armor
- C. Jesse begged Samuel to choose the youngest son
- D. Saul personally asked for David to replace him

**17. What did David's victory over Goliath show about his trust?**

- A. He trusted Goliath to fight fairly and leave Israel alone afterward
- B. He trusted the Lord more than weapons or size
- C. He trusted Saul's armor to protect him
- D. He trusted Israel's army to rescue him

**18. Why did Saul become jealous of David?**

- A. People praised David's victories, and Saul feared losing honor and power
- B. David refused to play music for Saul after every battle in Israel
- C. David stole Saul's crown in secret
- D. Jonathan told Saul that David was a Philistine spy

**19. How did Jonathan show covenant friendship to David?**

- A. He demanded that David serve him forever as a servant in Saul's house
- B. He left Israel to join the Philistine army
- C. He became king instead of Saul
- D. He protected David and remained loyal even when Saul hated David

**20. Why did David refuse to kill Saul when he had the chance?**

- A. He would not take revenge against the Lord's anointed king
- B. He was afraid Saul would win the fight if they met in an open valley
- C. He had promised Goliath not to use a sword
- D. He thought Saul had already died

**21. What wise action did Abigail take when David was angry at Nabal?**

- A. She told Saul where David was hiding and asked for a royal reward
- B. She brought food and pleaded for David not to take revenge
- C. She challenged David to single combat
- D. She ordered Nabal to become a priest

**22. Why was Saul's visit to the medium at Endor a sign of his collapse?**

- A. It showed he had become a better listener who now obeyed every word of God
- B. It proved Samuel was still ruling Israel
- C. It showed Saul seeking forbidden guidance because he was cut off from the Lord
- D. It caused the Philistines to surrender immediately

**23. What happened at Nob after the priest Ahimelech helped David?**

- A. Saul ordered the priests killed
- B. David became high priest over every priestly family in Israel
- C. Jonathan moved the tabernacle to Bethlehem
- D. The Philistines made peace with Israel

**24. Why did David spare Saul a second time near the camp?**

- A. He had forgotten that Saul wanted to kill him and thought the chase was over
- B. Saul's soldiers had already surrendered
- C. David wanted Abishai to become king instead
- D. He believed God, not David's own hand, should decide Saul's end

**25. How does 1 Samuel end?**

- A. David is crowned king over all Israel in Jerusalem during a joyful feast
- B. Samuel returns to judge Israel for many more years
- C. Saul and Jonathan die, leaving Israel grieving and David not yet fully king
- D. Goliath's family becomes loyal to Saul

### Section 3: Hard

**26. What major contrast does 1 Samuel make between Saul and David?**

- A. Saul is never brave, while David never sins and never needs correction
- B. Saul cares only about farming, while David dislikes sheep
- C. Saul is always poor, while David is born in a palace
- D. Saul often protects his own image, while David repeatedly shows trust in God's timing

**27. What does Samuel's life show about hearing God's word?**

- A. Faithful listening can be difficult, but God's word must be received and spoken truthfully
- B. God only speaks to adults who already understand everything before they serve Him
- C. A prophet's job is mainly to make people comfortable
- D. Children cannot serve God in meaningful ways

**28. How does the book warn readers about power?**

- A. Power is always wrong, even when God gives it to a leader for service
- B. Power can expose pride, fear, and disobedience if a leader does not trust the Lord
- C. Power only matters when a leader has strong weapons
- D. Power automatically makes a person wise

**29. Why is David's patience toward Saul important for understanding his character?**

- A. It proves David never felt afraid or angry in any dangerous moment
- B. It shows David wanted Saul to stay king forever
- C. It shows David could trust God's promise without grabbing the throne by murder
- D. It means David agreed with every choice Saul made

**30. What theme ties together Hannah, Samuel, Jonathan, Abigail, and David?**

- A. They all become kings of Israel and rule from Jerusalem for many peaceful years without enemies
- B. They all defeat Goliath in different ways
- C. They all reject prayer as unnecessary
- D. They show faithfulness to God in different situations where obedience costs something